

TELE SALES ESSENTIALS

Tele Sales Essentials — Day 5: Closing, Following Up and the Hiring Role-Play

Study guide · Self-study

Day 5: Closing, Following Up and the Hiring Role-Play

How to Use This Guide

This is Day 5 of Tele Sales Essentials. It is the last day, and it is the day everything you have practiced comes together. You will learn how to close a call without pressure, how to confirm what you agreed, how to follow up in a way you actually keep, and how to log every call so your work is visible. You will also get ready for the hiring role-play and interview, and for your first 90 days in the job.

Work through this guide in order. Write your answers before you read the model answers at the end. Say your lines out loud, because a close only sounds calm when your voice has practiced it. You need no tele sales job to do any of this. Every exercise gives you a no-job-yet option: a phone call with a friend, a recording of yourself, or a fictional customer printed right here.

Read one section, then try it. Reading without speaking teaches you the idea. Speaking teaches you the skill.

Today's Objectives (KASU)

Knowledge: You will know the five steps of the Commitment Close and why a client who can still say no commits more firmly.

Attitude: You will treat a close as the logical conclusion of a good conversation, not as pressure you apply at the end.

Skill: You will be able to close a call with a genuine choice and a date, confirm the agreement in the customer's own words, and log the call.

Upskill: You will be able to run a full recorded mock call from opener to close and review it against a self-check list, as practice for a hiring role-play.

Closing Without Pressure: The Commitment Close

Most new reps dread the close. They picture a moment where they push, and the client either gives in or hangs up. That picture is wrong, and it makes reps do two costly things: they rush to the ask before the client is ready, or they avoid the ask entirely and let a warm call fade away.

The close is not a separate event. It is the natural end of a call where you understood the need, showed one or two options, and answered what worried the client. When the work before it is done, the close is simply naming the next step.

The Commitment Close (MEDJAY adaptation, based on Voss, Kahneman, Dixon and Adamson, and Cialdini) is MEDJAY's close: the logical conclusion of the process, not pressure, and the client can still say no. It replaces the assumptive close, the old habit of acting as if the sale is already agreed. The Commitment Close has five steps, always in this order:

Criteria: Restate the client's own criteria. Say back what they told you matters, in their words.

Evidence: Show the evidence against those criteria. Point to what fits what they said.

Consequence: Name the consequences honestly, including when waiting is better. If waiting costs them nothing, say so.

Open question: Ask a how or what question. "What would you need to see to start on the 15th?" Not "Shall we go ahead?"

Genuine choice: Offer real choices of next step, with a date. "Would the 15th or the 22nd suit your team better?"

Why does a client who can still say no commit more firmly? Because pressure creates resistance. When a person feels pushed toward a decision, a natural reflex rises to protect their freedom of choice. Psychologists call this psychological reactance, and Brehm (1966) described it as a force that grows whenever a person senses their options are being closed off. A hard close triggers exactly that reflex. The client digs in, not because the offer is bad, but because being cornered feels bad.

The Commitment Close removes the corner. The client hears real options and a real date, and they hear that waiting is allowed. The need to resist disappears, so their attention goes back to the decision itself. Their yes, when it comes, is theirs. It also holds better afterward, because people stay loyal to decisions they feel they made freely.

There is a second reason the close works: it makes the decision easy to picture. A vague "I'll think about it" is comfortable because nothing is concrete yet. A date is concrete. Once a client sees the 15th on a calendar, they can finish the thought instead of postponing it.

Watch the word "but." In the close, do not argue. You are not defending the price or the plan. You are placing their own criteria next to the evidence and letting them decide.

Practice example: A small business owner told you her problem: her team misses customer calls while they are on site. You show a simple call-forwarding service and confirm the monthly cost. Criteria: "You told me the main thing is that calls stop going to voicemail while your team is out." Evidence: "This forwards every call to the mobile of whoever is on duty, and it takes about a day to set up." Consequence: "Every week without it is another week of missed calls. Waiting does give you time to check with your accountant, if that matters." Open question: "What would you need to see to have this running before the end of the month?" Genuine choice: "Would starting on the 15th or the 22nd work better for your team?"

Notice what did not happen. You did not say "So, can I send the contract?" You did not invent a deadline. You put the decision in the client's hands with two real paths forward.

> **NOTES**
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> Record yourself saying your close out loud five times. If you hear yourself speeding up at the end, slow down and breathe out before the final question.

Confirming in the Customer's Words and Follow-Up You Keep

A closed call can still fall apart after you hang up. The client remembers something different from what you remember, or nobody writes anything down, and the next step dies quietly. Two habits prevent this.

First, confirm in the customer's words. Before you end the call, repeat the agreement using the language the client used, not your product language. If they said "I need it sorted before the new staff start," use that sentence. Say the date, the price, and what happens next. Then ask one simple check: "Have I got that right?" This is a yes/no question for accuracy, not a commitment, so it is fine. What you are checking is that the picture in their head matches yours.

Why does this matter so much? People remember best what they said themselves and what they can picture. When your summary sounds like their own sentence, it feels familiar and true. When it sounds like a brochure, their attention drifts and doubt creeps in. Also, a person who has just heard their own words spoken back feels understood, and that feeling is what keeps the appointment in the calendar.

Second, set follow-up you actually keep. A promise to "call you next week" is easy to make and easy to break. A specific promise with a day and a time is different: "I will call you Thursday at ten with the exact start date." Write it down while the client is still on the line. Broken small promises cost more than people expect. A single missed callback outweighs several kept ones in the client's memory, so protect the ones you make.

Practice example: An insurance caller agrees to review a quote with her partner. You say: "So, to be clear: you will look at the quote with your partner tonight, and you want me to call Friday at six, after work, to answer anything that comes up. Have I got that right?" She says yes, and you write "Friday 18:00, callback, partner has questions" in your notes before the call ends.

> **NOTES**
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> If you catch yourself saying "I'll be in touch," stop and replace it with a day and a time. Vague promises are where deals quietly die.

Logging Every Call, and Handling Rejection and Volume

Logging feels like paperwork. Treat it as part of the sale, because it is. Every call needs a short record: who you spoke to, what they said in their own words, what you agreed, and the date of the next step. If there is no next step, log the outcome honestly, including a do-not-call request, which you log immediately and never revisit.

Why log every call, even the quick ones? Your memory of a busy day blurs. Notes in the client's own words let you pick up the conversation exactly where you left it, which makes the next call feel to them like a continuing relationship rather than a stranger phoning again. Logging also protects the client: a clear record of what they asked for and what they refused means nobody calls them again by mistake.

Now the harder part: rejection and call volume. On the phone you will hear "no" more often than any other word, and many of those no's come fast, sometimes before you finish your first sentence. Remember what you learned on Day 2: most early brush-offs are reflexes, not decisions. A real, clear no is different, and you respect it and log it. But the volume of quick rejections still wears people down if they take each one personally.

Here is the shift that protects you: a call outcome is information, not a verdict on you. Your job is to run each call well and learn from it. Some sessions produce few sales and still teach you a lot. Judge yourself on the parts you control: did you prepare one true reason per contact, did you open calmly, did you listen, did you log everything. That is your scorecard.

Your voice is a tool, and it needs care over a long session. Use the Physiological Sigh from Day 1 before a run of calls: two inhales through the nose, the second one short, then one long, slow exhale through the mouth. Brief structured breathing like this improved mood and lowered physiological arousal (Balban et al., 2023). It costs you seconds and steadies your pace for the next call.

> **NOTES**
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> After your next practice session, count how many calls ended with a clear next step or an honest close. That number tells you more than the number of no's.

Ready for the Hiring Role-Play and Your First 90 Days

A hiring role-play is a practice call with an interviewer playing the client. They are not testing whether you sound like a veteran. They are watching a few plain behaviors. Look at what they listen for:

A calm opener, with one true reason for the call.

Questions before any pitch. You find the need first.

A pause before you answer an objection or a hard question.

A close with a date, using an open how or what question, or two real choices.

Respect for a no. If the client says no clearly, you accept it, thank them, and log it.

Practice with a friend on the phone or record yourself. Treat each mock call as rehearsal for the real thing. When it goes well, notice why. When it does not, pick one behavior from the list and work on it next time.

Then prepare for two interview questions you will almost certainly hear. "Why tele sales?" Answer honestly, in your own words. Maybe you like talking to people and want a skill that travels. Maybe you want to learn sales from the ground up and phone work is where the real conversations happen. Say what is true for you, keeping it short. "How do you handle rejection?" Do not claim it never bothers you. Say what you actually do: you treat a no as information, you separate the call outcome from your own worth, and you keep a scorecard of the things you control. That answer sounds like a professional, and interviewers trust it more than bravado.

Now the first 90 days of a real job. Your first task is to learn the product and the contact rules before you chase numbers. Know what you can and cannot promise, and know the rules on who may be called, calling hours, do-not-call requests and recording notices. Follow local law and company policy, and log a do-not-call request immediately. Second, listen to strong callers. Ask to hear recordings of calls that went well, and notice their pace, their questions and their pauses. Third, keep your own call log from day one, in the format this guide has shown you.

Ask for one piece of feedback each week, and act on it before the next week. Judge yourself on what you control: preparation, opener, listening, objections, close, logging. Number anxiety fades once you have a record that shows your own progress.

Practice example: On your first day, your new manager asks what you will do in your first week. You answer: "I will learn the product and the contact rules first, listen to two strong call recordings each day, and start my own call log from my first shift. At the end of the week I would like one piece of feedback on my opener." That answer shows self-direction, respect for procedure, and a habit of measuring yourself honestly.

> **NOTES**
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> In an interview role-play, slow down before you speak. One calm breath, then your opener. The pause reads as confidence, not hesitation.

Apply It in Your Role

If you are job hunting: run a full mock call with a friend playing a fictional customer. Record it, opener to close. Then watch it back against the self-check list below.

If you already take calls: use a real call you are allowed to record and review, or run a mock one. Never write real names, numbers, or personal data in your practice notes.

Self-check list for your recording:

- ☐ I opened with a calm greeting and one true reason for the call.
- ☐ I asked short open questions and let the customer finish before I spoke.
- ☐ I reflected the customer's words back at least once.
- ☐ I paused before answering an objection, then used A.R.T. as one chain.
- ☐ I used the Commitment Close with all five steps in order.
- ☐ My final question was a how or what question, or two real dates.
- ☐ I confirmed the agreement in the customer's words and checked it.
- ☐ My follow-up has a day and a time.
- ☐ I logged the call, including the next step or the honest outcome.

What Would You Say?

Write your answer to each situation before you read the model answers. Say it out loud, then write what you said. Your words should sound like you.

Situation 1: Your client has agreed to a meeting, and you are about to end the call. What do you say to confirm the agreement in her words and set the follow-up?

Situation 2: You have run the full Commitment Close with a small business owner. She is quiet for a moment. What do you say next?

Situation 3: A hiring manager in your interview role-play says, "Close this call for me." What is your close?

Key Takeaways

A close is the logical end of a good call, not a push at the finish.

The Commitment Close has five steps in order: Criteria, Evidence, Consequence, an open question, and a genuine choice with a date.

A client who can still say no commits more firmly, because pressure triggers resistance and freedom removes it.

Confirm the agreement in the customer's own words and check that you got it right.

Make only follow-up promises you will keep, with a day and a time.

Log every call: who, what they said, what you agreed, and the next step. Log a do-not-call request immediately.

A rejected call is information, not a verdict on you. Score yourself on what you control.

Before a long session, use a slow-exhale breathing routine to steady your voice and mood.

Quiz

Choose one answer for each question. Write your answers before you check the notes.

1. What is the correct order of the Commitment Close?
   - **A.** Criteria, Evidence, Consequence, Open question, Genuine choice
   - **B.** Evidence, Criteria, Question, Consequence, Choice
   - **C.** Consequence, Choice, Evidence, Criteria, Question
   - **D.** Question, Evidence, Choice, Criteria, Consequence
2. Why can it be true that a client who is free to say no commits more firmly?
   - **A.** Because a free choice triggers reactance, which strengthens the yes
   - **B.** Because pressure makes people decide faster
   - **C.** Because pressure triggers resistance, and removing it lets the client decide for real
   - **D.** Because clients prefer to be told what to do
3. Which closing question fits the Commitment Close?
   - **A.** "Shall we go ahead?"
   - **B.** "Can I send the contract?"
   - **C.** "Would you like to sign up?"
   - **D.** "What would you need to see to start on the 15th?"
4. Which of these is a follow-up you actually keep?
   - **A.** "I'll be in touch next week."
   - **B.** "I'll call you Thursday at ten with the exact start date."

C. "Someone will get back to you soon."

D. "You'll hear from us."

5. What should you log after every call?

A. Only the sales you made

B. Who you spoke to, what they said in their own words, what you agreed, and the next step

C. Only the client's phone number

D. Nothing, to save time on calls

Upskill Challenge

Before you finish Day 5, complete this challenge. Run one full recorded mock call from opener to close, using the fictional customer below or a friend playing that customer. Watch it back against the self-check list and write a short review.

Practice example: Vera, 41, owns a two-van painting company. Her team misses calls while on site, and she loses jobs to the first competitor who answers. She wants calls handled without hiring a receptionist. She is cautious about monthly costs and wants everything clear before she agrees.

Write your review of your recording:

☐ My opener had one true reason and sounded calm.

☐ I asked short open questions and finished listening before I spoke.

☐ I reflected her words back at least once.

☐ I paused before each objection and used A.R.T. as one chain.

☐ I used all five steps of the Commitment Close in order.

☐ My close ended with a how or what question, or two real dates.

☐ I confirmed in Vera's words and checked I had it right.

☐ My follow-up has a day and a time.

☐ I logged the call with the next step or the honest outcome.

What was your strongest moment in the call: ____

What is one thing you will change before your next mock call: ____

Practice example: You make 20 mock calls in a week, reach 8 customers, have 5 real conversations and book 2 appointments. Your contact rate is 8 out of 20, and your conversion is 2 out of 5 conversations.

Calls made: ____

Calls that reached a customer: ____

Contact rate (reached divided by made): ____

Real conversations: ____

Appointments or sales: ____

Conversion (appointments divided by conversations): ____

Total next steps this week: ____

During your first 90 days in a real job, keep this same record from your own live calls, following your employer's rules on recording and data.

Model Answers

These are examples, not scripts. What matters is the principle behind each answer, and your words should sound like you.

Situation 1: "So, to be clear: you want the meeting after your busy season ends, so Thursday the 12th at two works. I will send the invite today and call you on the 5th to confirm. Have I got that right?" Why it works: it repeats her criteria, uses her own words, states the date, and checks for accuracy without pushing.

Situation 2: "What would you need to see to have this running before the end of the month?" Then stay silent. Why it works: the Commitment Close ends with an open how or what question, and silence lets her think instead of rescuing the deal for her.

Situation 3: "You told me the main thing is fewer missed customer calls. This service forwards every call to whoever is on duty, and it is set up within a day. Waiting costs you another week of missed calls, though checking with your partner first is fair. What would you need to see to have it running by the 15th? Would the 15th or the 22nd work better for your team?" Why it works: all five steps in order, ending with a real choice and a date.

Quiz answers:

1. A. The five steps run Criteria, Evidence, Consequence, open question, genuine choice, always in that order.

2. C. Pressure triggers reactance; removing it lets attention return to the decision, so the yes is the client's own.

3. D. The Commitment Close ends with a how or what question; A, B and C are yes/no closes.

4. B. A real follow-up has a day and a time; vague promises are easily broken.

5. B. A call record in the client's words with the next step lets you pick up where you left off and protects the client's requests.

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